

Note a few things:

- » I have more rules in the spending category than the accumulation category. If I had used this grid in my early twenties, there would have been more rules in the accumulation row. Over time, your rules will gradually change to match your relationship with your money.
- » Each box should have at least one rule. This helps you avoid the common tendency to wait until “someday” to focus on an area (which is usually spending).
- » Not all of my rules fit. Where would I put “Marry the right person” on this grid? I have no idea! This is intended to be a loose framework, and it can get a little messy in some cases.

Let’s start with your Money Rules today—then we’ll examine them many years down the road. Add your current rules below.

MONEY RULES GRID: TODAY

	SHORT TERM	LONG TERM
Accumulation		
Spending		

Now evaluate it. Which quadrant is most important to you? That’s where your Rules should be concentrated. For example, if you’re just starting out, you’ll want to focus on creating four or five rules in the short-term accumulation box. As you become more financially successful, you can shift more rules to the long-term accumulation box and the spending side.